

MULTI-UTILITY VEHICLES

MAHINDRA INGENIO

Rs 6.5-8 lakh (approx)

Specifications: 2.6-litre, 115 bhp; 2.2-litre, 125 bhp CRDe diesel engines

USP: An MUV with comfort of a car but built to a price. Six to eight seaters will also be available as utility van.

To compete with: Toyota Innova, Mahindra Scorpio and Chevrolet Tavera

MAHINDRA-RENAULT LOGAN MCV

Rs 6-8.5 lakh (approx)

Specifications: LxWxH (mm): 4450x1993x 1640; 1.4-litre, 75 bhp and 1.6-litre, 85 bhp petrol; 1.5-litre, 65 bhp dCi diesel

USP: Genuine seven-seater at an affordable price.

Gives great utility with low running costs.

To compete with: Hyundai Verna, Maruti SX4, Honda City, Chevrolet Tavera and Toyota Innova



TATA SUMO GRANDE

Rs 6.55-7.49 lakh

Specifications: 2.2 litre diesel

USP: An aesthetically better Sumo combines the looks of an SUV with the comforts of a family car. High torque ensures smoothness in stop-start traffic.

To compete with: Chevrolet Tavera, Mahindra Bolero etc



VOLKSWAGEN TIGUAN

Rs 20-25 lakh (approx)

Specifications: LxWxH (mm): 4430x1850x1.69; 2 litre petrol, 197 bhp; 2 litre diesel, 170 bhp

USP: A brand new SUV destined for India. Looks smart, versatile interiors offer benefits of a van.

To compete with: Ford Endeavour, Honda CR-V



CHEVROLET CAPTIVA

Rs 18 lakh

Specifications: LxWxH (mm): 4635x1850x 1755; 2 litre, 150 bhp diesel engine; automatic, manual front and all wheel drive

USP: Seven-seater true blue SUV with common rail diesel engine and contemporary looks. Good off road capability as well as on-road panache.

To compete with: Nissan X-trail, Honda CR-V



2008 but will also expand it at both ends.

For Hyundai, it will be the start of the i generation as further models in this series will be launched over the next couple of years. The

Korean car maker has been the boldest of the foreign car companies, giving India exclusive production for the third model in its global line-up, a trend that is being taken up by more of the companies. M&M has the Ingenio, a homegrown utility vehicle much in the mould of the Innova while Toyota itself will have a quiet 2008 with the new Corolla before it steps on the gas with its own small car, which I am presuming will be like the A-star. Mitsubishi has often announced its intentions to be reckoned amongst the top car makers in the world but for that it needs volumes, which it has often said will come from India. Now

is the time to get a move on and I hope to be hearing some announcements from them as well. The French brigade is conspicuous by its absence with Renault being the only serious player in the country but that should change in 2008 as well. Its own plant will get under construction this year and till then it will rely on completely built units as well as the Logan range to get a feel of the market. The next vehicle in the Logan range, the MCV is ideal for India as it provides a small seven-seater option and should be welcome for both the large family as well as the inter-city travellers.

With the Tata people's car now a reality and the Bajaj-Renault small car on the horizon, what does need to change rapidly is the availability of space to drive as well as park the cars—and that will be the biggest challenge of the year, apart from deciding which of the new models to go for.

The author is editor, Auto Bild India

SUVs